



Henry Fuseli, *The Nightmare* (1781)

PSYCHOSOCIAL RESEARCH ROUNDS

Prevalence of Common Parasomnias and Their Associations with Sleep Quality, Insomnia, Anxiety, and Depression Among Post-Secondary Students and Young Adults

Samantha Groppini

Session chaired by Vincent Paquin, MD

November 12, 2026

1:30 PM – 2:00 PM (ET)

ICFP Amphitheatre, 4333 Côte-St-Catherine Rd., Montreal QC H3T 1E4

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Learning objectives

- Describe the prevalence of common parasomnias among post-secondary students and young adults.
- Examine the associations between common parasomnias and sleep quality, insomnia, anxiety, and depression in this population.
- Discuss how the findings of this systematic review may inform future research, clinical practice, and sleep health initiatives for post-secondary students and young adults.

Abstract

Background: Common parasomnias, including sleep paralysis, nightmare disorder, sleepwalking, sleep talking, and sleep bruxism, are sleep-related disorders that may negatively affect sleep and psychological well-being. Although individual parasomnias have been investigated among post-secondary students and young adults, the available evidence has not been comprehensively synthesized.

Objective: To systematically review the literature examining the prevalence of common parasomnias and their associations with sleep quality, insomnia, anxiety, and depression among post-secondary students and young adults.

Methods: A systematic search of APA PsycINFO, MEDLINE (via PubMed), Embase, Scopus, Web of Science Core Collection, and ScienceDirect will be conducted to identify eligible observational studies published in English within the last 10 years. Two reviewers will independently screen studies, extract data, and assess methodological quality using Covidence. Data will be synthesized to summarize the prevalence of common parasomnias and their associations with sleep and psychological outcomes.

Results: The systematic review is currently underway. Study screening, data extraction, and quality assessment will be completed before the conference. The review will synthesize the prevalence of common parasomnias and their associations with sleep quality, insomnia, anxiety, and depression among post-secondary students and young adults, and identify gaps in the current literature.

Conclusion: This systematic review will provide a comprehensive synthesis of the available evidence on common parasomnias in post-secondary students and young adults. The findings are expected to inform future research, clinical practice, and sleep health initiatives aimed at improving student well-being.

About

Samantha Gropini is a research assistant at the Lady Davis Institute for Medical Research, Jewish General Hospital. She completed a Bachelor of Arts in Psychology with a Minor in Education at Concordia University and is currently pursuing a Master of Arts in Linguistics. Under the supervision of Dr. Dorrie Rizzo, she contributes to research on parasomnias and sleep-related difficulties among post-secondary students. Her work focuses on conducting systematic reviews, investigating the prevalence and psychological correlates of common parasomnias, and translating research findings into accessible resources for researchers, clinicians, and students.

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